The Lamp Illuminating the Instruction on the Four Realities

Tattvacaturupadeśaprasannadīpa · Toh 1242 · Derge Tengyur
དཔེ་ནོར་ཉིད་བཞི་པའི་མན་ངག་གསལ་བའི་སྒྲོན་མ

The Lamp Illuminating the Instruction on the Four Realities, known in Sanskrit as the Tattvacaturupadeśaprasannadīpa and in Tibetan as De kho na nyid bzhi pa'i man ngag gsal ba'i sgron ma, is a short tantric instruction text catalogued as Toh 1242 in the Tengyur, among the commentaries on the tantras. Opening with homage to Vajrasattva, it sets out, following the teaching of the master of Oḍḍiyāna, the four secret realities on which a practitioner should rely to gain the accomplishment of Hevajra. It belongs to the Hevajra cycle of the Highest Yoga Tantra and leads from meditation on the nature of awareness to the nonconceptual realization and conduct that culminate in the great seal, Mahāmudrā. Its colophon attributes it to the great accomplished master Tillipa, and records that it was translated, explained and finalized by the Indian preceptor Ratnaśrī.

In the language of India: tattva ca tu ra u pa de śa pra saṃ na dī paṃ nā ma. In the language of Tibet: The Lamp Illuminating the Instruction on the Four Realities.

Homage to glorious Vajrasattva.

The four secret realities are not realized by the learned; those devoted to the expanse realize them.
The accomplishment of Hevajra is far off, like a body trying to climb smoke or a mirage.
Therefore, following the guru's most excellent instruction, the treatise of the preceptor of Oḍḍiyāna,
I shall explain the four realities in brief for those whose devotion is very slight.

Now, one who wishes to obtain the accomplishment of Hevajra through the treatise of the most excellent guru, the preceptor of Oḍḍiyāna, should practice relying on the four realities. I shall explain them.

The four realities are these: the reality of the hand emblems and shapes; the reality of abiding, the four wheels; the reality of arrangement, the four joys of the awakening mind; and the reality of the culmination, the fourth. Four in all.

Of these, the lesser one, the reality of the hand emblems and shapes, consists of the thirty-two of the principal deity and the retinue and the three of the consort, thirty-five in all. The inner signs are outward: by the outer marks the inner is indicated. Moreover, these are method and wisdom. By distinguishing the right and left sides, there are thirty-two of wisdom and method. Of these, wisdom, because it makes known, makes realized and indicates, is the sixteen knowledges. Method, because it moves with compassion and brings forth, is the sixteen benefactions.

Further, the eight skull cups in the principal deity's left hands are object and subject: they are the signs of the abiding of the nature of reality and of the clarity of wisdom. The abiding of the nature of reality is the skull cups. As the sign of the clarity of wisdom, the eight deities make it clear and make it realized. If one asks what that means: because they make the object itself clear, they are called the clarifiers. If one asks on what they rely to make it clear: they rely on Pṛthivī, the earth goddess. She is the mudrā. That mudrā is of five kinds: the samaya, the wisdom, the mantra, the action, and the great mudrā. Because she is never separate from these, she is dhāraṇī, the one who holds. Therefore the goddess too is the sign of each of them. As the explanatory tantra says:

The samaya of all the buddhas
abides fully in the five mudrās.

Thus, because one seeks the path of liberation by relying on the mantra mudrā, the mudrā is Caṇḍālī. She is the fire deity. What brings the fire deity to completion is movement, the wind, and that is the wind deity. Being urged on by it, all signs of abiding are burned, so that what has the nature of the moon melts. What appears fully through that melting is the moon deity. Body and mind moistened by compassion is the water deity. When one is in the state of being fully satisfied by the water, the very clear light that appears as the sign of warmth is called the sun deity. By such means one will find the goal. As it is said, "When it is found, Yama then brings it to an end"; freed from that, one should let it expand. When that has been brought to its culmination, one will accomplish the wealth of the goal fully achieved.

If, though one strives again and again, one does not find the desired aim, then since it is not accomplished through the upper gate, one should train in the lower gate. How is this to be done? At the place of the navel, imagine a saṃ pu ṭi, a sealed casket formed from the moon and sun deities by the continuous

descent, and in its center place a very subtle bindu. Then, by means of the form of a letter, draw it out as a cord, and from a very fine opening fasten it, in the manner of a cord, to Īśvarī. In this the yogin should come to know it appearing small and large, and escaping, and should train with effort until the desired aim is found. This is the action of the sun and moon. If it is not accomplished even by that, one should likewise train in all four places as above; that is the moon, the sun and the rest. If even by that one does not meet with what is desired, one should train in the touch of the tip; that is called the action of fire and water.

If by these eight kinds of method it cannot be made to arise, then since it was not found by relying on oneself, the path of liberation, one should train in the path of passion, relying on another. Therefore one should rely on the action mudrā. This is the action of Yama. Having established the samaya with a qualified mudrā, one should train in experiencing that together with its aspect of nonconceptual nature. As the third chapter on empowerment says:

When the strainer is pressed with a finger,
though there is a hole, it does not drip.
As soon as the finger is released,
it flows out, as with the lesser need.
By the elder's instruction from the guru,
when sun and moon are seized by Rāhu,
though there is a hole, it does not drip.
When freed from Rāhu, the bindu is held back.
Knowing the four tastes, make the four tastes.
This is the vajra recitation.

Thus by training in the four tastes one will also find the goal. If one does not find it even by that, then since one has no fortune for liberation and ripening, one should cut that off and train in the path of self-consecration. Self-consecration is this: from the places of self and other one has become the nature of the clarity of wisdom, and through the state of acting for the benefit of sentient beings one has become profound wisdom; one should train in the path that surpasses that. If one asks what it is like: this too is Yama. Why? Because it brings about death.

Having completed the yoga of oneself, with light rays from the heart one should gather everything in and dissolve it into the heart itself. Then oneself also enters the heart and becomes hūṃ. The hūṃ in turn gradually dissolves

into the bindu. One should abide in that, which is like the tip of a flame. As it is said:

Like a lamp burning continuously,
and like the stream of a river, one should abide.

If one asks how one should abide at that time: the sun and moon are neither seized by Rāhu nor unseized; the strainer is not released; the bindu is not held back; in perfect balance, one should not regard consciousness as its own appearance. If one abides thus, one will find the desired aim. When the aim has been found, one should train in nonconceptuality alone. The goal fully accomplished by such effort is the true increase of the syllable of the fourth; it is like accomplishing the Wealth-Giver.

Furthermore, it abides also in the bodies of sentient beings, because a result without a cause is impossible. As it is said, "Great wisdom abides in the body." The body is the skull cup, the celestial mansion of bone. The phenomena abiding in it are the eight deities. Therefore the abiding is the channels.

That which is beyond expression, its quintessence like a thread of white silk, the strand like a tail hair split a hundred times, is in the Avadhūtī; the right one is the earth deity. Within it the quintessence of blood, like vermilion and lac, gathers, and so it is the water deity. Within it the quintessence of breath, which abides like a mere golden vapor, moves and stirs, and so it is its own deity, the wind. Within it the quintessence of heat, which abides clear like the light of a mirror, ripens and keeps things constant, and so it is the fire deity. Within it the actual all-base consciousness, which abides clear or obscured like the moon in water or like the disk of the rising sun, is called the sun and moon deities. At the time of realizing it, it is Vajrasattva with consort; at the ordinary time it appears as the all-base consciousness.

Then again, at the time when it becomes unclear and then clear, when the appearance of mind is obtained, or when consciousness and the sense faculties have ceased, that consciousness of the intermediate state of becoming is self-consecration. That is like the action of Yama. Then again, at the time of the three bodies, the manifest awakening through the stages of birth is the culminating phenomenon. Such is said to be like the Wealth-Giver. As the explanatory tantra says:

The Buddha abides in one's own body;
he does not exist anywhere else.
To hold that the Buddha is other than the body

is the way of those veiled by the obscuration of ignorance.
This is spoken in order to abandon a one-sided view.

Because it says so, and because it abides thus in the ordinary body, it should be understood as having the nature of what is called the ordinary path.

Now, the eight skull cups on the right are great loving-kindness. Because the nature of loving-kindness is unchanging and has become the basis, it appears as skull cups. The drinking of the two and the rest should be understood as the conduct of method and the activity of play, because, when wisdom like that above has become powerful, the deity protects sentient beings tormented by the three kinds of suffering. Moreover, it is held that he acts for the benefit of beings until saṃsāra is emptied. The hand emblems of the principal deity have been explained.

Next I shall explain those of the retinue. They are to rely on the instructions concerning self and other and on the three kinds of action. Since these too are to rely on method and wisdom, they are the union of method and wisdom. If one asks by what that union is symbolized: it is symbolized by the mudrā. If one asks what its sign and mark is: it is the tortoise. Therefore one attains by relying on the mudrā; that is the samaya mudrā and the rest.

At the stage of relying on oneself, that is, liberation, the mudrā of the eight-spoked wheel is that of mantra. If one asks how this is to be understood: the wheels are four. Contemplating them until the desired aim is found is the upper gate. When by that the desired aim has been found, these signs will arise: moving, leaping, breathing, trembling, scattering, intoxication, the arising of sounds, and signs like smoke as well. When a thought of desire arises, that is the culmination of the outer Caṇḍālī. Since the earlier thought is the enemy of the later one, at that time that enemy should be slain with the curved knife. If one asks where the enemy abides: it abides in the Lady of the Vajra Expanse. Then it abides in the place of the lower gate, the precious jewel. The bindu should be watched with the instruction of the strainer; at that time it should be spread by a sound like that of a ḍamaru or by union. What has spread rises back up and enters the upper gate. If one asks where the ball of light should be imagined: again in that very place above, with the sun and moon seized by Rāhu and the strainer not released, there will be the sense of expanding everywhere like a sleeping snake and of objects of touch having ceased. When it is so, wherever it goes, lead it straight there and bring the

training to completion. When it has been completed in this way, the wind will cease. The characteristics of the cessation of the wind are to be understood from the three stages.

If by such instruction the desired aim is not found, one should train relying on the path of passion, that is, on the action mudrā. If one asks why: as a monk, that is, without letting the seed descend, one should train in that complete bliss. Then it becomes power. When one has become free of fear, only then is one like a lion, and so one should train in nonconceptuality. If one asks why: because even through the union of the two organs one renders all things without intrinsic nature. Through such meditation the higher perceptions gradually arise. At first this is the arising of contaminated wisdom; relying on that, later at the stage of culmination the five wisdoms become directly manifest, and so it is the vajra. When they become directly manifest, the māras are subdued, and so it is the threatening forefinger.

Then, if neither liberation nor passion can make it arise and the desired is not found, one should train in self-consecration. If one asks what its sign is: the nature of what is examined is like the form of the vow, like a blazing lamp; being utterly free of fear, it is like a lion. If one asks why: because it is not overcome by the hosts of scattering winds. By such a path too one will find the path of meditation.

Having thus reached culmination, the full ripening of the aims of sentient beings and the acting for their benefit with various bodies is like the rohita fish, like the cooler, like the boar, like the axe, like the skull cup, and like the threatening forefinger. Though one thus acts inconceivably for the benefit of sentient beings, one is untainted by faults and the mind does not stir from nonconceptuality; hence the two skull cups.

Now, the three of the consort: at the time when the goal is fully accomplished, the curved knife is the consort without reference point, and the skull cup filled with blood is the consort with reference point. By that very one comfort is given: even having directly accomplished the body of reality, the Teacher, whose body is endowed with the supreme of all aspects, abides as the body of perfect enjoyment, possessing the seven branches to be accomplished; this is the desired khaṭvāṅga.

Having thus explained the reality of the lesser shapes of the hand emblems, now, since one knows the body as the abode of great wisdom, and since without the body the wheels are not found, I shall explain the reality of the

four wheels. The wheels are the wheels of the channel wheels. If one asks whether they abide in the body on their own, without a cause: they abide in the manner of support and supported. If one asks what the support is: it is the channels. If one asks how many there are: the principal ones number seventy-two thousand.

From these come one hundred and sixty. From those, one hundred and twenty. From those, thirty-two. From those, three. Those are the principal ones. Of these, the one hundred and twenty are the four wheels. If one asks where each of them is located: at the navel, the heart, the throat and the crown of the head. If one asks how they are numbered: at the navel there are sixty-four, at the heart eight, at the throat sixteen, and at the crown thirty-two. If one asks what their shape is like: like the petals of a lotus meeting the light of the sun, open and lustrous. As for their color, since they arise from the courses of the sun and moon, they are like a moonstone glazed with fresh butter. If one asks in what manner they abide: because method and wisdom are joined, they abide in union.

Since this arises from the manifest awakening of the supported, it is a term for "the result adorned with the letters of the major and minor marks." If one asks how they are set out in number: in the emanation wheel, by the ā li and the kā li; in the Dharma wheel, the sequence of letters to be indicated is the nine fathers and mothers; in the enjoyment wheel, oṃ and yar va la, five; and in the wheel of great bliss, the ā li doubled.

If one asks how the definite number of these four is set: the numbers of the wheels are set according to the number of the divisions of time in the world. If one asks what the divisions of time are: they correspond to the numbers of the watches, the transitions, the water-clock periods and the staff-measures. Of these, there are eight watches, sixteen transitions, thirty-two water-clock periods, and sixty staff-measures. Therefore that too is the wheel itself.

Then, if one asks why these four wheels are called emanation, Dharma, enjoyment and great bliss: the secret place of the navel is the source of everything, and so it is the place from which emanation arises. The heart, being the place of knowing, is the body of reality. The throat is so called because it experiences and enjoys the six tastes. The crown is so called because it has become the place or the cause of great bliss. They are also set out in sequence by the moments, in the order of the varied, maturation, consciousness, and freedom from characteristics. The four truths are suffering,

origin, cessation and the path. The four realities are the reality of the self, of mantra, of the deity and of wisdom. The four joys are joy, supreme joy, the joy of severance, and innate joy. The four schools are the Sthaviras, the Sarvāstivādins, the Sāṃmitīyas and the Mahāsāṅghikas. Through such sequences they are known by the names emanation and the rest.

Then, if one asks of what nature these four wheels are: they are of the nature of body, speech and mind. They are e vaṃ ma ya. e is the goddess Locanā; vaṃ is said to be Māmakī; mā is called the Red-Clad Lady; ya is said to be Tārā. If one asks in what manner they abide: emanation is wisdom, the source of phenomena. The lotus of the heart is called the samaya wheel; because it always gazes upon the Lady of the Expanse of Reality, it is union. Then, if one asks what the countenance of the expanse of reality is like: because it has always become the enjoyment of the five tathāgatas, it is enjoyment. If one asks how it is complete: being like the form of one sixteen years old, it possesses the radiance of youth; adorned with three bracelets, it has the moods of grace and the rest; adorned with the five letters of the elements, the bha ga is fully developed. If one asks how it is developed: the five channels are the abode of the four tastes, and the four tastes are the tastes of bliss; because it has become their abode, it is developed. If one asks how it becomes enjoyment: because it has become the abode of a bliss like space, it is perfect enjoyment. Because one constantly focuses upon that and it drips, it is great bliss. If one asks what kind of great bliss: the great bliss endowed with five special features, arising from the meditative absorption distinguished by body and mind. If one asks what its action is: because it flows uninterruptedly from the bell, the result too becomes great bliss. That too, being of the nature of union, is method and wisdom.

If one asks how the wisdom of great bliss is to be obtained from such wheels: it is found by circulating fully. If one asks how one circulates: according to the guru's instruction, one should join the two principal channels, the wind channel and the sleep channel. That generates the wind. That makes Caṇḍālī blaze intensely. That makes the emanation wheel blaze intensely. That fully burns the conceptions of the samaya wheel. Then, circulating fully through the Maiden channel, it is drawn out on the right, performs the purpose of outer offering, and enters on the left. Then, circulating leftward in the maṇḍala of great bliss, it opens the door of the vital point and enters the hearts of the buddhas of the ten directions, where it becomes the nectar of wisdom. Carrying the nectar back, it dissolves into what is called Jālandhara. By this the

enjoyment wheel too is filled. Entering by the left channel, it nourishes the emanation wheel as well. Then it enters on the right, dissolves outward into the enjoyment wheel, and only then is the samaya maṇḍala fully nourished. Then, dissolving once again into the emanation wheel, it blazes greatly. And as it circulates again as before, its going up and going down is not seen, even to the measure of a hair tip split a hundred times. By doing this, one will find the desired aim.

If, though one does this again and again, it is not found, one should train by placing four bindus in the four wheels. If it is not found even by that, one should train from the two, aṃ haṃ. If it is not found even by that, one should train from aṃ and hūṃ. By doing this, one will find the desired aim. When it is found, the eight tastes arise; when they arise, the māra of the gods is slain with the curved knife. Then it is to be fully dissolved, and that resembles a coiled snake. When it has become so, the lion cub is nurtured. Such a nature is called the culmination from the four wheels; this has been explained.

Then, to one who wonders, "O Blessed One, are the wheels alone what is to be practiced?": no, because the vow has also been explained. One should train in the four joys of the awakening mind. The four joys are the joy of the continuum, supreme joy, the joy free of joy, and innate joy. If one asks what kind of joy the four joys are: the category of experiencing the result born of the assemblage and that which is assembled is called joy. If one asks how it is experienced: I shall explain the joy experienced at the time of samaya.

If one asks why it is called the joy of the continuum: when the lotus and the vajra, as born from the treatises on passion, touch completely, that is called the moment of the varied, and the knowledge that takes it as its object is called wisdom-knowledge (prajñājñāna). Then, abiding in the middle of the vajra, fully ripened by the condition of stirring, is called supreme joy. Then the treasury of wisdom, the kha kha mu kha, and the jewel touch completely, and at the time of friction one becomes free of all thoughts; therefore it is called the joy free of joy. That is called the wisdom-knowledge attained in its place. With the joy born from such touch acting as the dominant condition, in the later moment there arises at the tip of the jewel the nonconceptual aspect, whose nature is free of all characteristics and free of all reference points. That is called innate joy, and it is called the experienced wisdom-knowledge.

These four joys are of two kinds: the joy of the ślo ka and the order of arising. If one asks why it is called ślo ka: it is wisdom and gnosis. Wisdom is held to be

nirvāṇa, and gnosis is saṃsāra. Not abiding in either of the two is supreme for the Mādhyamikas. Since it transcends that, it is the sa ha ja, the innate. That is Hevajra. Therefore innate joy is held to come last. Those who hold them to be body, speech and mind maintain that "severance" refers to what has passed. As it is said:

As it arises, it is semen.
The innate is of two kinds:
first, the woman is wisdom;
method is said to be the man.
Then each of these is twofold,
to be divided into ultimate and relative.
First, the man is of two kinds:
the semen, or its bliss.
As with the man, so with wisdom:
the semen, or its bliss.
For that reason joy
is divided into four.
Since the innate is fourfold,
the aspect of the completion stage,
supreme joy is the yoginī,
and joy free of joy is all;
know all that bliss to be of method.
Slight bliss is joy;
supreme joy exceeds that;
joy free of joy is freedom from passion;
innate joy is the last.
The first is the desire for touch;
the second is the desire for bliss;
the third is grasping at passion;
therefore one should meditate on the fourth.
Supreme joy is called existence;
being free of passion, it is nirvāṇa;
the lesser is mere joy.
The sa ha ja is free of all of these.
There is no passion and no freedom from passion,
nor is it apprehended as a middle.
In it there is neither method nor wisdom;

it is the realization of perfect reality.
The innate is not produced by another;
it is not found anywhere at all.
Through the guru's timely teaching of the means
and through merit, one knows it oneself.

So it is said. To train in such joy, one brings the bliss down into the center of the jewel. By reckoning four parts in each wheel, and so reckoning four for each such joy, there are the sixteen transitions of yoga.

Having explained the reality of the four joys of the awakening mind, I shall next explain the reality of the fourth. If one asks what kind of fourth: what is attained by meditating with regard to the third is called the fourth. If one wonders what such a nature would be like: the fourth indicated as the object and the fourth indicated by likeness are called the fourth. That is called the culminating phenomenon. The phenomenon is the perfect limit; the culmination is the profound. If one asks by what name it goes: it is the nature of the abiding of the nature of reality and the nature of the clarity of wisdom. It is the nature of the nature of reality just as it is, and of the nature of mind just as it is. Their nondifference is Vajrasattva, the body of pure essential nature. Therein the luminous maṇḍala of mind is the reality of secret mantra. Such an object, the ultimate truth, is the fourth indicated as the object, and it is called the culminating.

Then, if one asks how it is indicated by likeness: it is indicated by that joy of conceiving wisdom-knowledge. When the culminating thing to be accomplished, which has been ascertained through meditation, has become directly manifest and endowed with the seven branches, it takes the primordial nature of reality as its object and becomes inseparable from the nature of the clarity of the mirror-like wisdom, in which the root consciousness is purified in its place; this is called the fourth indicated by likeness. Such a fourth, moreover, is indicated and made known by the nature of joy, and so that is the indicator. If one asks how it indicates it, the tantra says:

The lesser, the middling and the supreme,
the other, whichever, and that too:
all of these in sameness
are to be seen by meditating on reality itself.
The lesser is the meaning of a subtle thing;

it is spoken of as the supreme thing;
by the middle way the two are abandoned.

And so on. Thus the explanatory tantra also says:

One should not meditate on emptiness,
nor meditate on non-emptiness.
The yogin should not abandon emptiness,
nor abandon non-emptiness either.
If one grasps both the empty and the non-empty,
many thoughts arise.
If both are fully abandoned, one realizes the real.
Therefore one should abandon these two.
Having fully abandoned clinging to both,
one abides with certainty in liberation.
This perfect realization as a self:
therefore that too is truly to be abandoned.

Because it says so, the Blessed One taught that not knowing those three extremes is meditation on reality. As it is also said:

Where there is no meditator,
and no non-meditation either,
and meditation too has no fixed form,
that is called meditating on reality.

Thus, having understood and realized the reality of the sa ha ja, one sees things as without difference, and this is said to be meditating on all phenomena in their own respective natures. As it is said:

Meditating on all beings
is so because they are not meditated on by the mind.
When all phenomena are fully known,
meditation itself is not meditation.
Whatever things there are, moving and unmoving,
grasses, vines, creepers, branches and the rest,
one surely meditates on them as that supreme reality,
each thing in its own nature.
There is no single supreme one among them.
Perfect self-awareness is the meditation;
it is born from what is unlike

the nature of one's own awareness.

Because it says so. By abiding in such śaṃ pra meditation, when nonconceptuality arises without interruption, that is also the attainment of the ten grounds. When nonconceptual knowing arises without interruption, then the command of prophecy is given, and after that one comes to abide in the conduct of the Avadhūtī.

Abiding in that conduct, one acts for the benefit of sentient beings for countless eons. And in that very life one also unites with a yoginī of the right family and with the very limit of reality (bhūtakoṭi). Thus the attainment of the accomplishment of Mahāmudrā is the complete fulfillment of the purpose; and for one who has become the yoga endowed with the seven branches, it is called the fourth that illustrates by likeness. When the purpose has been completely fulfilled in this way, one should also come to know how the Teacher abides. An instruction of this kind is called the reality of the fourth.

As for the four realities:
Indivisible in union by way of cause and result,
free of thing and no-thing, of bliss and of suffering,
this, endowed with the mode in which nothing whatever is apprehended,
may it meet with those who yearn for the Dharma.
Realizing the four realities, swiftly attaining Hevajra,
may the hosts of ailing beings of the three realms be healed.

The Lamp Illuminating the Instruction on the Four Realities, composed by the great master Tillipa, who gained accomplishment in the land of glorious Oḍḍiyāna, is complete. It was translated, explained and finalized by the Indian preceptor Ratnaśrī himself.

Translator's Notes

• "Path of liberation" in the passage on Caṇḍālī reads a Tibetan spelling meaning "deviation," evidently a slip for the word "liberation" used later in the text. The "very subtle bindu" renders a syllable pair that ordinarily means "blessing," taken here as a phonetic spelling of bindu. "The lesser need" in the quoted verse is literal and appears to mean urination. In the description of the final abiding, "the strainer is not released" renders an obscure phrase whose verb is uncertain. "Yama" here is used figuratively for the cessation or "death" of the ordinary process; the "Wealth-Giver" is likely Kubera (Dhanada). "Self-consecration" renders the term for svādhiṣṭhāna.
• The opening "strand" renders the word otherwise used for sūtra, here in its root sense of a thread or fine channel; "a tail hair split a hundred times" is a probable reading of an obscure

simile. "Its own deity, the wind" renders a phrase that reads "its own deity," apparently a slip for "the wind deity," which the series requires. "Scattering" among the signs is uncertain. "Bindu" once appears in a misspelled form and is read as bindu. The emblems listed (rohita fish, boar, axe, skull cup, threatening forefinger, tortoise, monk, lion, ḍamaru, wheel, vajra) correspond to those held by the goddesses of the Hevajra maṇḍala; "the cooler" could not be identified with confidence and is translated literally.

• "The joy of severance" in the first list renders the Tibetan as written; in the second list the corresponding joy is "the joy free of joy," and the first may be a variant spelling of it. The third goddess is named "the Red-Clad Lady" as the Tibetan reads; in the usual set this place is held by Pāṇḍaravāsinī, the White-Clad. "Water-clock periods" and "staff-measures" render Indian units of time (ghaṭikā and a related measure). "The Maiden channel" translates a channel name that could not be identified with confidence. The four moments are given here as the varied, maturation, consciousness, and freedom from characteristics; the third differs from the usual list, but is kept as written.

• "Wisdom-knowledge" renders prajñājñāna, the term also used for the third empowerment. The two kinds of joy, "of the śloka" and "the order of arising," are given as the Tibetan has them; "śloka" here likely denotes the ordering of the joys as recited in the verse, but the sense is uncertain. The last two lines of the final quoted verse are difficult and are rendered literally. "Śaṃprati meditation" is left in its Sanskrit form as the Tibetan transcribes it.

• □□□□□□□□□□□□□ is rendered as the technical term "limit of reality" (bhūtakoṭi) rather than the glossary's "extreme," since it is a fixed compound. The phrase "the fourth that illustrates by likeness" (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□) is rendered literally; its exact technical sense in this system is not fully certain. The seven branches are presumably the seven branches of union (kha sbyor yan lag bdun) characterizing the Vajradhara state.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.